

COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Cold War End and New World Order - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Cold War End and New World Order - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-01. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-01.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was used first. The available OCR-searchable Norman Lowe World History PDF was retained as supplementary local context, but no unsupported page number, quotation or precision was imported from it.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** No direct UPSC PYQ is verified as owned solely by this topic in the local routing blocks. All six Mains demands are original practice.
- **Live-link boundary:** The U.S. State Department's National Museum of American Diplomacy is scheduled to open to the public in October 2026 and houses a signed Berlin Wall segment associated with major actors in the diplomacy of 1989-91 and German reunification. The changeable opening claim was rechecked on 4 September 2026. Official US, German, UN and Indian pages separately control Soviet dissolution, Two Plus Four, Resolution 678 and India's post-Cold-War recalibration. The museum object is only a public-history link, not evidence for a single-cause Cold War ending or a final Western 'new world order'.
- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete World History Core is taught chronologically, spatially and causally before optional enrichment.
Evidence method	Claim -> named event/treaty/institution/actor/region or attributed scholarship -> analysis -> qualification.
Chronology	Structural cause, trigger, event, settlement, implementation and long-term process remain distinct.
Geography	Europe, Africa, Asia, West Asia and the Americas retain their own actors, routes and unequal connections; Europe is never the default universal viewpoint.
Historiography	Liberal, conservative, Marxist, social, feminist, postcolonial and other relevant interpretations are tied to evidence and bounded claims.
Practice contract	Every solved item has directive/demand decoding, an examiner/grade model, an executable timed/compression plan, marks rationale and answer/specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved: false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner:

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\World-History\basic\21_Cold-War-End-and-New-World-Order.md

Canonical topic owner:

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Optional Advanced owner:

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\World-History\advanced\21_Cold-War-End-and-New-World-Order.md

Official syllabus mapping:

EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- **Primary/official evidence:** treaties, declarations, laws, institutional records, speeches and contemporary testimony are dated and read for authorship, audience and purpose.
- **Spatial and social evidence:** maps, trade and migration routes, battlefield geography, class, race, gender and colonial position qualify state-centred narrative.
- **Quantitative evidence:** population, debt, inflation, output, casualties and territorial claims retain unit, place, period, source and uncertainty; no statistic is invented.
- **Interpretive discipline:** teleology, civilisational ranking, single-cause verdicts and present-day nation-state projection are rejected.
- **PYQ discipline:** repository routing ledgers and locally held papers control wording and metadata; neutral rendering, reconstruction and unavailable official keys remain explicitly labelled.
- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-04:** The U.S. State Department's National Museum of American Diplomacy is scheduled to open to the public in October 2026 and houses a signed Berlin Wall segment associated with major actors in the diplomacy of 1989-91 and German reunification. This supplies a narrow public-history link to renewed attention to Cold War-ending diplomacy; the object is not evidence for a single-cause account of the Cold War's end or a single-cause 'new world order'.

Live/primary context sources recorded by the predecessor generation:

- <https://diplomacy.state.gov/about-nmad/>
- <https://diplomacy.state.gov/berlin-wall/>

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - Gorbachev's rescue project

VISUAL FIRST

GORBACHEV'S RESCUE PROJECT

01. Gorbachev's reform intent, 1985

|

v

02. Glasnost

|

v

03. Perestroika

BOUNDARY -> Intent, openness and restructuring are separate analytical questions.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** Gorbachev's rescue project is the source-bounded relationship among Gorbachev's reform intent, 1985, Glasnost and Perestroika within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union.
- Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed.

- Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Intent, openness and restructuring are separate analytical questions.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in Gorbachev's reform project.
- **Mains:** Explain the reform paradox.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Gorbachev's reform intent, 1985 -> Glasnost -> Perestroika
- **Qualified use:** Explain the reform paradox.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - Structural burdens and causation debate

VISUAL FIRST

STRUCTURAL BURDENS AND CAUSATION DEBATE

01. Structural burdens

|

v

02. Multi-causal end debate

BOUNDARY -> No single-cause victory narrative is sufficient.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** Structural burdens and causation debate is the source-bounded relationship among Structural burdens and Multi-causal end debate within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform.
- Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- No single-cause victory narrative is sufficient.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in Structural burdens and causation debate.
- **Mains:** Build a weighted causation answer.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Structural burdens -> Multi-causal end debate
- **Qualified use:** Build a weighted causation answer.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - Poland and Hungary

VISUAL FIRST

POLAND AND HUNGARY

01. Poland and Hungary, 1988-89

|
v

02. Eastern Europe and the Wall, 1989

BOUNDARY -> Eastern European society and reform communists followed different routes.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** Poland and Hungary is the source-bounded relationship among Poland and Hungary, 1988-89 and Eastern Europe and the Wall, 1989 within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route.
- East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Eastern European society and reform communists followed different routes.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in Poland and Hungary.
- **Mains:** Restore agency below Moscow.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Poland and Hungary, 1988-89 -> Eastern Europe and the Wall, 1989
- **Qualified use:** Restore agency below Moscow.

SESSION 4 - CORE - The revolutions of 1989

VISUAL FIRST

THE REVOLUTIONS OF 1989

01. Eastern Europe and the Wall, 1989

|
v

02. Poland and Hungary, 1988-89

BOUNDARY -> Peaceful and violent transitions must not be collapsed.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** The revolutions of 1989 is the source-bounded relationship among Eastern Europe and the Wall, 1989 and Poland and Hungary, 1988-89 within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script.
- Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Peaceful and violent transitions must not be collapsed.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in The revolutions of 1989.
- **Mains:** Compare East Germany, Czechoslovakia and Romania.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Eastern Europe and the Wall, 1989 -> Poland and Hungary, 1988-89
- **Qualified use:** Compare East Germany, Czechoslovakia and Romania.

SESSION 5 - CORE - German reunification

VISUAL FIRST

GERMAN REUNIFICATION

01. German reunification, 1990

|
v

02. Eastern Europe and the Wall, 1989

BOUNDARY -> The Wall opening and legal reunification are distinct.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** German reunification is the source-bounded relationship among German reunification, 1990 and Eastern Europe and the Wall, 1989 within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy.
- East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The Wall opening and legal reunification are distinct.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in German reunification.
- **Mains:** Join popular mobilisation to interstate settlement.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** German reunification, 1990 -> Eastern Europe and the Wall, 1989
- **Qualified use:** Join popular mobilisation to interstate settlement.

SESSION 6 - CORE - Republics and Yeltsin

VISUAL FIRST

REPUBLICS AND YELTSIN

01. Republican sovereignty

|
v

02. Yeltsin as rival centre

BOUNDARY -> Territorial institutions and elite rivalry interacted.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** Republics and Yeltsin is the source-bounded relationship among Republican sovereignty and Yeltsin as rival centre within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened.
- Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Territorial institutions and elite rivalry interacted.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in Republics and Yeltsin.
- **Mains:** Explain dual sovereignty inside the USSR.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Republican sovereignty -> Yeltsin as rival centre
- **Qualified use:** Explain dual sovereignty inside the USSR.

SESSION 7 - CORE - August coup and Soviet dissolution

VISUAL FIRST

AUGUST COUP AND SOVIET DISSOLUTION

01. Failed coup, August 1991

|
v

02. Soviet dissolution, December 1991

BOUNDARY -> The failed restoration attempt accelerated exit.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** August coup and Soviet dissolution is the source-bounded relationship among Failed coup, August 1991 and Soviet dissolution, December 1991 within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union.
- Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The failed restoration attempt accelerated exit.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in August coup and Soviet dissolution.
- **Mains:** Complete the 1991 dissolution chain.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Failed coup, August 1991 -> Soviet dissolution, December 1991
- **Qualified use:** Complete the 1991 dissolution chain.

SESSION 8 - CORE - Gulf War as order test

VISUAL FIRST

GULF WAR AS ORDER TEST

01. Gulf War order test, 1990-91

|
v

02. US unipolar moment and limits

BOUNDARY -> Council-authorised coalition enforcement is not blue-helmet peacekeeping.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** Gulf War as order test is the source-bounded relationship among Gulf War order test, 1990-91 and US unipolar moment and limits within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait.
- The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Council-authorised coalition enforcement is not blue-helmet peacekeeping.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in Gulf War as order test.
- **Mains:** Identify the early new-order promise.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Gulf War order test, 1990-91 -> US unipolar moment and limits
- **Qualified use:** Identify the early new-order promise.

SESSION 9 - CORE - The unipolar moment

VISUAL FIRST

THE UNIPOLAR MOMENT

01. US unipolar moment and limits

|
v

02. Gulf War order test, 1990-91

BOUNDARY -> Capability, legitimacy and control are different tests.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** The unipolar moment is the source-bounded relationship among US unipolar moment and limits and Gulf War order test, 1990-91 within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government.
- Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Capability, legitimacy and control are different tests.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in The unipolar moment.
- **Mains:** Define both predominance and limit.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** US unipolar moment and limits -> Gulf War order test, 1990-91
- **Qualified use:** Define both predominance and limit.

SESSION 10 - CORE - Yugoslav fragmentation

VISUAL FIRST

YUGOSLAV FRAGMENTATION

01. Yugoslav fragmentation

|
v

02. NATO after bipolarity

BOUNDARY -> Nationalism was politically produced inside institutional collapse.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** Yugoslav fragmentation is the source-bounded relationship among Yugoslav fragmentation and NATO after bipolarity within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred.
- Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Nationalism was politically produced inside institutional collapse.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in Yugoslav fragmentation.
- **Mains:** Reject the ancient-hatreds shortcut.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Yugoslav fragmentation -> NATO after bipolarity
- **Qualified use:** Reject the ancient-hatreds shortcut.

SESSION 11 - CORE - NATO beyond territorial defence

VISUAL FIRST

NATO BEYOND TERRITORIAL DEFENCE

01. NATO after bipolarity

|
v

02. Yugoslav fragmentation

BOUNDARY -> Dayton and Kosovo belong to different stages.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** NATO beyond territorial defence is the source-bounded relationship among NATO after bipolarity and Yugoslav fragmentation within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation.
- Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Dayton and Kosovo belong to different stages.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in NATO beyond territorial defence.
- **Mains:** Test adaptation and legitimacy together.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** NATO after bipolarity -> Yugoslav fragmentation
- **Qualified use:** Test adaptation and legitimacy together.

SESSION 12 - CORE - European Union settlement

VISUAL FIRST

EUROPEAN UNION SETTLEMENT

01. European Union settlement

|
v

02. Globalisation within the order

BOUNDARY -> Integration has pre-1991 roots and post-1991 geopolitical effects.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** European Union settlement is the source-bounded relationship among European Union settlement and Globalisation within the order within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states.
- Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Integration has pre-1991 roots and post-1991 geopolitical effects.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in European Union settlement.
- **Mains:** Explain deepening and widening.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** European Union settlement -> Globalisation within the order
- **Qualified use:** Explain deepening and widening.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Globalisation inside the order claim

VISUAL FIRST

GLOBALISATION INSIDE THE ORDER CLAIM

01. Globalisation within the order

|
v

02. Global South agency

BOUNDARY -> Topic 20 owns the economy; this topic owns the political-order inference.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** Globalisation inside the order claim is the source-bounded relationship among Globalisation within the order and Global South agency within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived.
- Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Topic 20 owns the economy; this topic owns the political-order inference.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in Globalisation inside the order claim.
- **Mains:** Bound liberal convergence.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Globalisation within the order -> Global South agency
- **Qualified use:** Bound liberal convergence.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - Global South agency

VISUAL FIRST

GLOBAL SOUTH AGENCY

01. Global South agency

|
v

02. India's bounded relevance

BOUNDARY -> Postcolonial sovereignty survives unipolarity.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** Global South agency is the source-bounded relationship among Global South agency and India's bounded relevance within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order.
- For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Postcolonial sovereignty survives unipolarity.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in Global South agency.
- **Mains:** Add a non-Western analytical lens.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Global South agency -> India's bounded relevance
- **Qualified use:** Add a non-Western analytical lens.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - India and the qualified verdict

VISUAL FIRST

INDIA AND THE QUALIFIED VERDICT

01. India's bounded relevance

|

v

02. Multi-causal end debate

|

v

03. US unipolar moment and limits

BOUNDARY -> India detail remains Economy- and IR-owned.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CONCEPT DEFINITIONS

- **Precise definition:** India and the qualified verdict is the source-bounded relationship among India's bounded relevance, Multi-causal end debate and US unipolar moment and limits within Cold War End and New World Order.
- **Classification:** Historical facts below are source-backed; causal weight and evaluative verdicts are analytical synthesis.

CORE EXPLANATION

For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned.
- Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult.
- The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- India detail remains Economy- and IR-owned.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact actor, date, document and category in India and the qualified verdict.
- **Mains:** Conclude without Western teleology.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** India's bounded relevance -> Multi-causal end debate -> US unipolar moment and limits
- **Qualified use:** Conclude without Western teleology.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: History (World History) · **Tier:** Basic (foundation) · **GS Paper:** GS-I with GS-II linkage **Grounded in:** Norman Lowe, *Mastering Modern World History* (5th ed.), Chapter 18, Chapter 10 (esp. collapse in Eastern Europe and Yugoslavia), and Chapter 12 + official UPSC GS-I/GS-II syllabus lines. **FACT:** = from Lowe / official syllabus · **ANALYSIS:** = synthesis / analytical linkage · **CURRENT:** = current affairs. *Companion:* advanced/21_Cold-War-End-and-New-World-Order.md.

Mini-timeline

Date /​ phase	Event
FACT: 1985	Gorbachev comes to power in the USSR
FACT: 1988-​89	Solidarity forces negotiation in Poland; communist regimes collapse across Eastern Europe
FACT: 9 November 1989	Berlin Wall is opened
FACT: 12 September /​ 3 October 1990	Two Plus Four Treaty is signed /​ Germany is reunified
FACT: 29 November 1990	UN Security Council Resolution 678 authorises member states cooperating with Kuwait to use "all necessary means" if Iraq does not withdraw
FACT: August-​December 1991	Failed hard-​line coup, republican exits, dissolution of the USSR and Gorbachev's resignation
FACT: 1992-​93	Maastricht Treaty is signed and enters into force, creating the European Union
FACT: 1991-​95	Yugoslavia descends into wars of breakup
FACT: 1999	Kosovo crisis and NATO intervention
FACT: 2004	Major eastern enlargement of the European Union

1. Snapshot and syllabus anchor

- FACT: Official UPSC GS-I syllabus covers world-history themes including redrawing of national boundaries and political ideologies.
- FACT: Official GS-II syllabus line - **"Important International institutions, agencies and fora - their structure, mandate"** - becomes relevant here through NATO, the UN and post-Cold-War intervention.
- ANALYSIS: This topic is three linked stories: ****dissolution of Soviet power, negotiated and violent redrawing of European boundaries, and the promise and limits of a US-led post-Cold-War order****.
- ANALYSIS: Scope discipline: the long Cold War belongs to Topic 15; the world economy since 1900 belongs to Topic 20; present-day international relations belongs to the IR owners. This file uses the Gulf War, Yugoslavia, NATO, European integration and globalisation only to test the historical "new world order" claim.

2. Gorbachev's reform project: rescue that destabilised the system

Reform /​ choice	Historical purpose	Destabilising effect
FACT: Glasnost (openness)	Release dissidents, widen public discussion and expose bureaucratic failure	Criticism became legitimate before a trusted replacement order existed
FACT: Perestroika (restructuring)	Decentralise and modernise party, government and economy	Partial reform disrupted command mechanisms without producing a functioning market
FACT: Political reform	Revive socialism through participation and accountability	Televised debate and competitive elements weakened the CPSU's monopoly
FACT: New foreign-​policy thinking	Reduce confrontation, arms burdens and coercive control over Eastern Europe	Satellite regimes lost the expectation of Soviet military rescue

- FACT: Gorbachev wanted a humane, democratic socialism inside a reformed one-party framework; he did **not** enter office intending to abolish communism or dissolve the USSR.
- ANALYSIS: The sequencing problem is central: glasnost raised expectations and organised criticism faster than perestroika improved daily life or created stable institutions.

3. Why did the Cold War end? A multi-causal debate

Causal family	What it explains	Why it is insufficient alone
FACT: Economic stagnation and technological weakness	Loss of performance legitimacy and inability to modernise civilian production	Armed states can survive stagnation through coercion
FACT: Defence and imperial burdens	Resources were diverted from consumption and modernisation; Afghanistan added strain	Burden does not explain the timing or peaceful character of withdrawal
FACT: Gorbachev's agency	Reform, arms diplomacy and non-intervention changed the rules of bloc control	One leader acted inside accumulated structural constraints
FACT: Society from below	Solidarity, civic groups, churches, workers and demonstrators converted openings into political change	Organisation and sequence differed greatly by country
FACT: Nationality mobilisation	Republics offered alternative loyalties and sovereign institutions	Nationalism strengthened because central authority and ideology were already weakening
FACT: Western pressure and diplomacy	Arms competition and engagement affected Soviet calculations; Reagan responded to Gorbachev	A triumphalist "West defeated the USSR" thesis ignores Soviet and Eastern European agency

MEMORY: **Balanced verdict:** structural weakness made reform urgent; reform altered incentives and released opposition; organised societies and republics supplied alternatives; diplomacy and the refusal to use mass force made reversal increasingly difficult.

4. Eastern Europe in 1989: one regional wave, different national routes

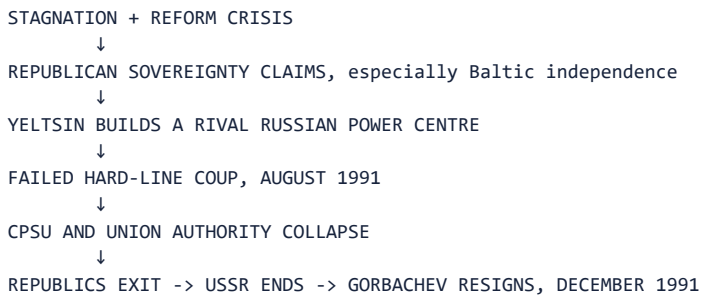
- FACT: Communist systems in Eastern Europe weakened rapidly once Moscow no longer guaranteed repression.
- FACT: In Poland, Solidarity's August 1988 strikes helped force negotiation and elections in June 1989; organised opposition and bargaining were decisive.
- FACT: Hungary's reform communists accepted competitive change and opened the border with Austria, weakening East Germany's ability to contain exit.
- FACT: East German demonstrations, elite division and the opening of the Berlin Wall on **9 November 1989** ended the physical symbol of European division.

- FACT: Czechoslovakia's Velvet Revolution transferred power with little violence.
- FACT: Romania's overthrow was violent; therefore "1989" was not a single peaceful script.
- ANALYSIS: Moscow's restraint created the opportunity; national actors determined the route and pace.

5. German reunification: diplomacy, sovereignty and boundary settlement

- FACT: The opening of the Berlin Wall did not itself reunify Germany.
- FACT: The **Two Plus Four Treaty**, signed on **12 September 1990** by the two German states and the four former occupying powers, settled Germany's external status, borders and sovereignty.
- FACT: Reunification took legal effect on **3 October 1990**.
- ANALYSIS: German reunification demonstrates that the end of the Cold War was negotiated as well as revolutionary: popular pressure opened the question, but interstate diplomacy settled it.
- WRONG: Do not confuse nineteenth-century German unification under Prussia with reunification of the Federal Republic and German Democratic Republic in 1990.

6. How the Soviet Union dissolved



- FACT: The USSR was a federation of fifteen union republics with institutions that could become vehicles for sovereignty once central control weakened.
- FACT: Lithuania declared restoration of independence in March 1990; Baltic mobilisation was part of a wider republican challenge.
- FACT: Boris Yeltsin's election as leader of the Russian republic created a rival democratic and territorial source of authority inside the union.
- FACT: The failed hard-line coup of August 1991 destroyed much of the remaining legitimacy of the CPSU and accelerated republican exits.
- FACT: Gorbachev resigned on **25 December 1991**; the sequence was dissolution of a multinational state, not merely a change of government in Moscow.

7. The early "new world order": promise and first test

Feature	Evidence inside this topic	Analytical limit
FACT: US unipolar moment	The USSR disappeared and the United States possessed unmatched global military reach	Predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy or unlimited control
FACT: UN Security Council alignment	Resolution 678 of 29 November 1990 authorised member states cooperating with Kuwait to use all necessary means after the deadline	The Gulf War was coalition enforcement authorised by the Council, not a UN-commanded blue-helmet operation
FACT: Gulf War, 1990-1991	Iraq's invasion of Kuwait was reversed by a broad US-led coalition	A successful interstate coalition did not provide a general solution for civil wars or state collapse
ANALYSIS: Liberal-order confidence	Markets, elections and international institutions appeared to be expanding together	Yugoslavia and post-Soviet disruption quickly disproved a simple final-peace thesis

MEMORY: Unipolarity is a distribution of capability; order additionally requires rules, legitimacy, institutional consent and the ability to manage different kinds of conflict.

8. Yugoslavia and NATO: the limits of the 1991 template

- FACT: In Yugoslavia, the end of communism interacted with aggressive nationalism and bad leadership.
- FACT: Serbia under Milosevic, Croatia under Tudjman and the mixed population of Bosnia made compromise difficult.
- FACT: Bosnia witnessed ethnic cleansing, huge refugee flows and international hesitation before stronger intervention.
- FACT: The **Dayton settlement (1995)** ended the Bosnian war but did not settle Kosovo.
- FACT: NATO's **1999 Kosovo intervention** showed the alliance moving beyond territorial defence while also exposing dispute over authorisation, sovereignty and humanitarian claims.

- ANALYSIS: **Doctrine cross-link:** what collapsed here was a *regime type*, not the socialist idea as such - see basic/01 §9.2 and §9.3(f)-(g) before writing any "the collapse of communism proved socialism failed" sentence.

9. European integration and globalisation within the new-order question

Stage	Why it matters
FACT: European Coal and Steel Community, 1951-1952	Pooled strategic industries to make renewed Franco-German war less likely
FACT: Treaty of Rome, 1957	Six states created the European Economic Community
FACT: First enlargement, 1973	Britain, Ireland and Denmark joined, widening the Community
FACT: Maastricht, 1992-1993	The European Union added a broader political and monetary framework
FACT: Eastern enlargement, 2004	Former communist states entered the Union, linking integration to the post-Cold-War settlement

ANALYSIS: European integration was both a peace project and an economic-political bargain. Its history is not a smooth march to federation: sovereignty concerns, uneven economies and the tension between **deepening** and **widening** remained persistent.

- ANALYSIS: Globalisation belongs thematically to Topic 20. Here it matters only as part of the post-1991 order: expanding trade, finance, production networks and market reform strengthened confidence in liberal convergence, but gains and policy space remained unequal.
- ANALYSIS: Do not turn this topic into a history of the WTO, financial crises or present-day trade.

10. Postcolonial, Global South and India relevance

- ANALYSIS: The end of bipolarity did not make postcolonial states passive recipients of a Western order. They continued to bargain through regional organisations, the UN, commodity and trade coalitions, and issue-based partnerships.
- ANALYSIS: The language of a single liberal destination obscured unequal starting capacities, debt, structural-adjustment pressures and the fact that sovereignty remained a central political value across the Global South.
- ANALYSIS: For India, 1991 joined two shocks: the loss of the familiar Soviet strategic setting and a severe balance-of-payments crisis. The analytical relevance is **recalibration**-economic liberalisation, diversified major-power relations and movement from non-alignment's bipolar setting toward strategic autonomy.
- ANALYSIS: India-specific economic reform and foreign-policy detail belongs to the Economy and International Relations owners. Use this World History topic only to establish the changed systemic context.

11. Must-Know Facts (Prelims) and UPSC traps

- FACT: **Gorbachev** is linked with **glasnost** and **perestroika**.
- FACT: Berlin Wall opening (**9 November 1989**), German reunification (**3 October 1990**) and Soviet dissolution (**December 1991**) are distinct milestones.
- FACT: The **failed August 1991 coup** accelerated, rather than prevented, Soviet dissolution.
- FACT: **Yeltsin** became the leading figure in post-Soviet Russia.
- FACT: **Dayton (1995)** is associated with the Bosnian peace settlement.
- FACT: The **Treaty of Rome (1957)** created the EEC; **Maastricht** was signed in 1992 and entered into force in 1993.
- FACT: The **1991 Gulf War** was Security Council-authorised coalition enforcement, not ordinary UN peacekeeping.

MEMORY: Trap: The end of the Cold War did not produce a stable peace; it produced new conflicts in new forms.

- WRONG: Gorbachev intended to destroy communism -> he tried to reform and save it.
- WRONG: Western pressure alone ended the Cold War -> structural weakness, reform, social and national mobilisation, diplomacy and non-coercion interacted.
- WRONG: The Berlin Wall's opening automatically reunified Germany -> the Two Plus Four settlement and 3 October 1990 legal reunification were later stages.
- WRONG: The USSR simply "became Russia" -> fifteen union republics became independent states and Russia inherited only part of the former union's identity and authority.
- WRONG: Yugoslavia broke up only because of ancient hatreds -> leadership choices, institutions and external hesitation mattered too.
- WRONG: European integration began only after the Cold War -> its institutional roots reach back to the ECSC and EEC in the 1950s.
- WRONG: US unipolarity meant uncontested world government -> capability, legitimacy and control are different tests.

13. Exam linkage, Mains angles and probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Recurring UPSC theme:** why political systems collapse when reform weakens coercion faster than it creates legitimacy.
- Analyse the causes of the collapse of communism in the USSR and Eastern Europe.
- Explain how German reunification combined popular revolution and great-power diplomacy.
- "The Cold War ended through interaction between structural decay and political choice." Discuss.
- Did the Gulf War confirm a new world order, or only a brief alignment of power and institutions?
- Discuss the breakup of Yugoslavia as a post-Cold-War crisis of nationalism and state failure.
- Assess the US unipolar moment and its limits from a Global South perspective.
- Explain how European integration changed from a Cold-War peace project into a post-Cold-War enlargement project.

14. Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

Core-sufficiency note: this file must independently support the Soviet-collapse causation, Yugoslavia, European integration and post-1991-order demands, non-teleologically. advanced/21 adds the Gorbachev-Yeltsin debate only.

14.1 Directive and demand map

If the question says	It is really testing	Do NOT write
Analyse the causes of the collapse of communism	Structural decay plus reform choices plus the decision not to coerce	"Communism failed"
Discuss the breakup of Yugoslavia	Nationalism as a political product, not an ancient inheritance	"Ancient hatreds"
Did a "new world order" emerge?	Gulf War alignment, US predominance, institutions and their limits	A post-2001 current-affairs narrative
Explain European integration's change	From Cold-War peace project to post-Cold-War enlargement project	A treaty timeline
Redrawing of boundaries after 1991	Soviet successor states, Yugoslav successor states, German reunification	Only the USSR

14.2 Qualified thesis templates

- ANALYSIS: **Collapse**: "Soviet communism was not defeated; it was dismantled from above by leaders who tried to reform it and then declined to shoot in order to save it."
- ANALYSIS: **Yugoslavia**: "Yugoslavia did not break up because its peoples could not live together; it broke up because, once the federal and communist framework dissolved, political entrepreneurs found ethnic mobilisation the cheapest route to power."
- ANALYSIS: **New world order**: "The post-1991 order was unipolar in capability but plural in

sovereignty and legitimacy: the Gulf coalition showed unusual alignment, while Yugoslavia exposed weak consensus over civil war and intervention."

- ANALYSIS: **Non-teleological rule**: "The collapse of Soviet communism was not proof that every state would converge on one political-economic model; outcomes depended on institutions, social coalitions, state capacity and external constraints."

14.3 Mark-scaled structures

Marks	Structure
10	Thesis -> two causes of collapse or two features of the new order -> one qualification -> verdict
15	Thesis -> why communism collapsed -> what replaced it in Europe -> the contested new order -> verdict
20	All of the above -> plus German reunification, Gulf War, Yugoslavia, EU/globalisation, Global South agency and explicit non-teleology -> verdict

14.4 Evidence bank A - why communist rule collapsed (four converging causes)

Cause	FACT: Evidence	ANALYSIS: Mechanism	Caution
Economic stagnation	FACT: The Soviet command economy could not deliver enough efficiency or consumer welfare	Removed the performance-based legitimacy that had replaced revolutionary legitimacy	ANALYSIS: Stagnation alone does not topple an armed state
Reform that outran control	FACT: Glasnost and perestroika loosened the system without stabilising it; FACT: openness encouraged more opposition than the Party could control	Reform legalised criticism faster than it delivered improvement	ANALYSIS: FACT: Gorbachev intended to reform and save communism, not destroy it
National mobilisation	FACT: Soviet republics demanded more autonomy and then independence	A multinational state loses its centre when the ideology binding it fails (see basic/13 §9.7)	ANALYSIS: Nationalism was a consequence of weakening control as much as a cause
Elite alternative	FACT: Yeltsin emerged as a radical alternative to Gorbachev's cautious reformism	Gave the opposition a leader and a rival power centre inside the system	-
The decisive omission	FACT: Gorbachev did not use old-style Soviet force to preserve communist rule in eastern Europe (basic/15)	Without the guarantee of Soviet intervention, FACT: eastern European communist systems weakened rapidly	ANALYSIS: This is a <i>choice</i> , not an inevitability - that is the whole point
Societal mobilisation from below	FACT: The process "began in Poland in August 1988 " when the Solidarity trade union organised huge anti-government strikes that eventually forced the government to negotiate (§3)	The decisive omission above created the <i>opportunity</i> ; organised society supplied the <i>agency</i> that used it - without which the collapse would have been a reform programme, not a revolution	ANALYSIS: Do not generalise Poland's organised opposition to every eastern European state; the sequence and the social base differed

ANALYSIS: **The pairing to write in an answer**: Moscow's refusal to coerce and Poland's capacity to mobilise are the two halves of one explanation. Naming only the first makes the collapse a Kremlin decision; naming only the second makes it inevitable. FACT: Lowe's own sequence has both.

14.5 Evidence bank B - dissolution and German reunification

Process	FACT: Evidence	ANALYSIS: Analytical significance
Republican exit	FACT: Baltic independence mobilisation and wider sovereignty claims	Federal units became state-building platforms once the centre weakened
Rival centre	FACT: Yeltsin led the Russian republic against union and party authority	The largest republic helped dissolve the union it had dominated
Failed coup	FACT: August 1991 hard-line coup failed	Coercive restoration destroyed the authority it sought to save
German settlement	FACT: Two Plus Four Treaty, 12 September 1990; reunification, 3 October	Popular change required an interstate sovereignty settlement
Final dissolution	FACT: Gorbachev resigned, 25 December 1991	End of union, presidency and party rule were related but distinct processes

14.6 Evidence bank C - Yugoslavia: nationalism as political production

Factor	FACT: Evidence	ANALYSIS: Analytical significance
Institutional dissolution	FACT: In Yugoslavia the end of communism interacted with aggressive nationalism and bad leadership	The federal framework failed before the violence began
Leadership choice	FACT: Serbia under Milošević, Croatia under Tuđman, and the mixed population of Bosnia made compromise difficult	Names the <i>agents</i> : this is what defeats the "ancient hatreds" answer
Atrocity and displacement	FACT: Bosnia witnessed ethnic cleansing, huge refugee flows and international hesitation before stronger intervention	The clearest post-1945 European case of mass forced displacement
Incomplete settlement	FACT: Dayton (1995) settled Bosnia; FACT: Kosovo later showed the crisis did not end there; FACT: NATO intervention, 1999	Settlements that freeze conflicts are not the same as settlements that resolve them
ANALYSIS: Social consequence	ANALYSIS: Refugees, minority displacement and contested successor-state borders became the era's characteristic European problem	Connects directly to the syllabus phrase "redrawing of national boundaries"

14.7 Evidence bank D - Gulf War and the unipolar-order test

Test	FACT: Evidence	ANALYSIS: Significance
Institutional alignment	FACT: Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline	Unusual Security Council agreement enabled enforcement
Capability	FACT: A US-led coalition reversed Iraq's occupation of Kuwait	Displayed the military asymmetry of the emerging unipolar moment
Category	FACT: Coalition enforcement, not UN-commanded peacekeeping	Prevents the blue-helmet trap
Limit	FACT: Yugoslavia soon produced slower, contested responses	Interstate aggression and internal state collapse required different political solutions

14.8 Evidence bank E - European integration: peace project, market bargain, enlargement

Stage	FACT: Evidence	ANALYSIS: Why it mattered
ECSC, 1951-52	FACT: Pooled strategic industries to make renewed Franco-German war less likely	Integration began as security policy by economic means
Treaty of Rome, 1957	FACT: Six states created the EEC	Widened the bargain from coal and steel to a common market
First enlargement, 1973	FACT: Britain, Ireland and Denmark joined	Widening begins to compete with deepening
Maastricht, 1992-93	FACT: The EU added a broader political and monetary framework	Deepening reaches sovereignty questions directly
Eastern enlargement, 2004	FACT: Former communist states entered the Union	Integration became the institutional settlement of the Cold War's end

ANALYSIS: FACT: **Mandatory qualification:** European integration was both a peace project and an economic-political bargain; its history is **not** a smooth march to federation - sovereignty concerns, uneven economies and the tension between **deepening** and **widening** remained persistent. FACT: Its roots reach back to the ECSC and EEC in the 1950s, not to 1991.

14.9 Evidence bank F - Global South and India

Dimension	ANALYSIS: Safe analytical use	Ownership limit
Postcolonial sovereignty	End of bipolar discipline widened options but did not remove hierarchy, debt or intervention	Do not portray the Global South as one bloc
Globalisation	Market integration expanded while gains, vulnerability and policy space remained unequal	Topic 20 owns detailed world-economic history
India	1991 required strategic and economic recalibration after Soviet collapse and the balance-of-payments crisis	IR owns strategic autonomy; Economy owns liberalisation and the crisis
Non-teleology	Liberal convergence was a claim, not a predetermined historical law	Use evidence from divergent post-Soviet and Yugoslav outcomes

14.10 Verdict scaffolds

- **"Why did communism collapse?"** -> "Economic failure made the system indefensible, reform made criticism legal, nationalism supplied the alternative loyalty, and the refusal to use force made the outcome irreversible - the last of these was a decision, not a law of history."
- **"Yugoslavia?"** -> "A state failure that was converted into an ethnic war by leaders who found nationalism the most available political resource, and prolonged by external hesitation."
- **"New world order?"** -> "Real as a brief concentration of capability and Council alignment, but incomplete as an order: Yugoslavia, uneven globalisation and continuing postcolonial sovereignty exposed the limits of universal convergence."
- **"European integration?"** -> "It changed from a device for containing Germany into a device for absorbing the post-communist east - and both functions were pursued without resolving the sovereignty question either raised."

14.11 Factual-risk controls

- WRONG: Do not say Gorbachev intended to destroy communism. FACT: He tried to reform and save it.
- WRONG: Do not treat glasnost and perestroika as synonyms. FACT: Openness and restructuring had different mechanisms.
- WRONG: Do not merge the Berlin Wall opening, Two Plus Four settlement, German reunification and Soviet dissolution into one event.
- WRONG: Do not omit the August 1991 coup from dissolution dynamics.

- WRONG: Do not explain Yugoslavia by "ancient hatreds". FACT: Leadership choices, institutions and external hesitation mattered too.
- WRONG: Do not say European integration began after the Cold War. FACT: Its roots are the ECSC and EEC in the 1950s.
- WRONG: Do not call the Gulf War ordinary UN peacekeeping. FACT: It was Council-authorised coalition enforcement.

- WRONG: Do not give casualty, refugee, membership or GDP figures; none is sourced here.
- WRONG: Do not date the sequence loosely. FACT: Wall **9 November 1989**; Two Plus Four

12 September 1990; reunification **3 October 1990**; Resolution 678 **29 November 1990**; failed coup **August 1991**; Gorbachev resignation **25 December 1991**; Maastricht signed **1992**, in force **1993**; Dayton **1995**; Kosovo/NATO **1999**; eastern enlargement **2004**.

- WRONG: Do not extend this file past **2013**. ANALYSIS: 00_Master-Chronology.md §5 records that Lowe's 5th edition ends there; any post-2013 claim must be a separately dated CURRENT: current-affairs anchor, never presented as part of the historical narrative.
- FACT: **Solidarity may be named**: FACT: the trade union whose huge anti-government strikes in **August 1988** began the eastern European sequence. WRONG: Do not add its membership, leadership, agreements or the round-table detail; none is sourced here.
- WRONG: Do not write that the collapse of communism proved socialism failed. ANALYSIS: What collapsed was a **regime type** - see basic/01 §9.2 for the socialism ≠ communism ≠ social democracy discipline before drawing any doctrinal conclusion.

15. Study link

Study link: advanced/21_Cold-War-End-and-New-World-Order.md for the Gorbachev-Yeltsin debate and evaluative frameworks (optional). **Study link:** for communism's earlier rise, revise basic/17_China-Communism-and-Asia.md and basic/13_Russian-Revolution-and-USSR-under-Stalin.md. **Study link:** World-History -> basic/01_Enlightenment-and-Age-of-Revolutions-Overview.md §9 for what communism, socialism and social democracy are as doctrines - required before any verdict on what 1989-91 disproved. **Study link:** World-History -> basic/15_Cold-War-and-International-Relations.md for the rivalry that ended here, and §10.6A for the bloc division that preceded the collapse. **Study link:** World-History -> basic/16_United-Nations-and-Global-Governance.md for the institutional limits Iraq 2003 exposed. **Study link:** World-History -> basic/18_Decolonization-of-Africa-and-Asia.md §7.7(e) for the same "an authoritarian regime that starts reforming cannot stop halfway" mechanism in South Africa. **Study link:** World-History -> basic/20_World-Economy-and-Population-since-1900.md for the economic globalisation of the same period. **Study link:** Economy -> basic/16_Industrial-Policy-1991-Reforms-PSUs-and-Disinvestment.md and International Relations -> basic/01_Foreign-Policy-Foundations-and-Strategic-Autonomy.md own India's post-1991 detail.

WORLD HISTORY DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** Gorbachev's reform phase, Eastern European revolutions of 1989, Two Plus Four settlement and German reunification in 1990, failed August 1991 coup and December Soviet dissolution are distinct stages.
- **Close distinction:** Economic stagnation, nationality pressures, legitimacy loss, arms burdens, reform sequencing, social mobilisation, non-coercion and diplomacy interacted; neither Western pressure nor one leader alone is sufficient.
- **Evidence / interpretation limit:** The Gulf coalition displayed US-led unipolar capability, while Yugoslavia, NATO controversy, unequal globalisation and continuing Global South and Indian agency deny final-peace or Western-teleology claims.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Gorbachev's reform intent, 1985?

A. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. B. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. C. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. D. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform.

Answer: A. Explanation: Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Gorbachev's reform intent, 1985?

A. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. B. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. C. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. D. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult.

Answer: B. Explanation: Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Gorbachev's reform intent, 1985?

A. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. B. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. C. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. D. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route.

Answer: C. Explanation: Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Gorbachev's reform intent, 1985?

A. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. B. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. C. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. D. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union.

Answer: D. Explanation: Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Glasnost?

A. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. B. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. C. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. D. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult.

Answer: A. Explanation: Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Glasnost?

A. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. B. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. C. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. D. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route.

Answer: B. Explanation: Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Glasnost?

A. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. B. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. C. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. D. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script.

Answer: C. Explanation: Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Glasnost?

A. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. B. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. C. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. D. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed.

Answer: D. Explanation: Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Perestroika?

A. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. B. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. C. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. D. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route.

Answer: A. Explanation: Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Perestroika?

A. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. B. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. C. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. D. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script.

Answer: B. Explanation: Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Perestroika?

A. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. B. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. C. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. D. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy.

Answer: C. Explanation: Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Perestroika?

A. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. B. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. C. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. D. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed.

Answer: D. Explanation: Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Structural burdens?

A. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. B. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. C. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. D. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script.

Answer: A. Explanation: Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Structural burdens?

A. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. B. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. C. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. D. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy.

Answer: B. Explanation: Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Structural burdens?

A. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. B. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. C. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. D. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened.

Answer: C. Explanation: Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Structural burdens?

A. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. B. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. C. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. D. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform.

Answer: D. Explanation: Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Multi-causal end debate?

A. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. B. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. C. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. D. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy.

Answer: A. Explanation: Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Multi-causal end debate?

A. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. B. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. C. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. D. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened.

Answer: B. Explanation: Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Multi-causal end debate?

A. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. B. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. C. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. D. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU.

Answer: C. Explanation: Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Multi-causal end debate?

A. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. B. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. C. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. D. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult.

Answer: D. Explanation: Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Poland and Hungary, 1988-89?

A. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. B. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. C. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. D. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened.

Answer: A. Explanation: Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Poland and Hungary, 1988-89?

A. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. B. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. C. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. D. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU.

Answer: B. Explanation: Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Poland and Hungary, 1988-89?

A. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. B. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. C. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. D. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union.

Answer: C. Explanation: Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Poland and Hungary, 1988-89?

A. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. B. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. C. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. D. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route.

Answer: D. Explanation: Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Eastern Europe and the Wall, 1989?

A. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. B. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. C. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. D. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU.

Answer: A. Explanation: East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Eastern Europe and the Wall, 1989?

A. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. B. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. C. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. D. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union.

Answer: B. Explanation: East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Eastern Europe and the Wall, 1989?

A. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. B. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. C. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. D. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change.

Answer: C. Explanation: East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Eastern Europe and the Wall, 1989?

A. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. B. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. C. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. D. East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script.

Answer: D. Explanation: East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies German reunification, 1990?

A. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. B. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. C. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. D. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under German reunification, 1990?

A. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. B. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. C. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. D. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of German reunification, 1990?

A. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. B. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. C. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. D. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about German reunification, 1990?

A. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. B. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. C. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. D. The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Republican sovereignty?

A. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. B. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. C. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. D. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change.

Answer: A. Explanation: Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Republican sovereignty?

A. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. B. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. C. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. D. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait.

Answer: B. Explanation: Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Republican sovereignty?

A. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. B. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. C. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. D. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government.

Answer: C. Explanation: Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Republican sovereignty?

A. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. B. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. C. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. D. Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened.

Answer: D. Explanation: Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Yeltsin as rival centre?

A. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. B. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. C. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. D. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait.

Answer: A. Explanation: Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Yeltsin as rival centre?

A. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. B. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. C. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. D. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government.

Answer: B. Explanation: Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Yeltsin as rival centre?

A. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. B. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. C. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. D. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred.

Answer: C. Explanation: Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Yeltsin as rival centre?

A. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. B. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. C. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. D. Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU.

Answer: D. Explanation: Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Failed coup, August 1991?

A. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. B. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. C. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. D. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government.

Answer: A. Explanation: The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Failed coup, August 1991?

A. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. B. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. C. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. D. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred.

Answer: B. Explanation: The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Failed coup, August 1991?

A. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. B. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. C. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. D. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Failed coup, August 1991?

A. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. B. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. C. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. D. The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union.

Answer: D. Explanation: The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Soviet dissolution, December 1991?

A. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. B. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. C. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. D. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred.

Answer: A. Explanation: Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Soviet dissolution, December 1991?

A. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. B. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. C. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. D. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation.

Answer: B. Explanation: Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Soviet dissolution, December 1991?

A. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. B. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. C. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. D. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states.

Answer: C. Explanation: Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Soviet dissolution, December 1991?

A. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. B. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. C. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. D. Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change.

Answer: D. Explanation: Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Gulf War order test, 1990-91?

A. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. B. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. C. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. D. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation.

Answer: A. Explanation: Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Gulf War order test, 1990-91?

A. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. B. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. C. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. D. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states.

Answer: B. Explanation: Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Gulf War order test, 1990-91?

A. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. B. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. C. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. D. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived.

Answer: C. Explanation: Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Gulf War order test, 1990-91?

A. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. B. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. C. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. D. Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait.

Answer: D. Explanation: Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies US unipolar moment and limits?

A. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. B. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. C. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. D. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states.

Answer: A. Explanation: The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under US unipolar moment and limits?

A. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. B. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. C. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. D. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived.

Answer: B. Explanation: The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of US unipolar moment and limits?

A. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. B. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. C. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. D. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order.

Answer: C. Explanation: The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about US unipolar moment and limits?

A. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. B. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. C. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. D. The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government.

Answer: D. Explanation: The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Yugoslav fragmentation?

A. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. B. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. C. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. D. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived.

Answer: A. Explanation: Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Yugoslav fragmentation?

A. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. B. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. C. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. D. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order.

Answer: B. Explanation: Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Yugoslav fragmentation?

A. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. B. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. C. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. D. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned.

Answer: C. Explanation: Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Yugoslav fragmentation?

A. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. B. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. C. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. D. Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred.

Answer: D. Explanation: Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies NATO after bipolarity?

A. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. B. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. C. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. D. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order.

Answer: A. Explanation: Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under NATO after bipolarity?

A. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. B. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. C. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. D. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned.

Answer: B. Explanation: Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of NATO after bipolarity?

A. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. B. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. C. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. D. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union.

Answer: C. Explanation: Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about NATO after bipolarity?

A. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. B. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. C. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. D. Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation.

Answer: D. Explanation: Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies European Union settlement?

A. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. B. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. C. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. D. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned.

Answer: A. Explanation: ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under European Union settlement?

A. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. B. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. C. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. D. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union.

Answer: B. Explanation: ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of European Union settlement?

A. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. B. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. C. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. D. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed.

Answer: C. Explanation: ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about European Union settlement?

A. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. B. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. C. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. D. ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states.

Answer: D. Explanation: ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Globalisation within the order?

A. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. B. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. C. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. D. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union.

Answer: A. Explanation: Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Globalisation within the order?

A. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. B. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. C. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. D. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed.

Answer: B. Explanation: Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Globalisation within the order?

A. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. B. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. C. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. D. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed.

Answer: C. Explanation: Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Globalisation within the order?

A. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. B. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. C. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. D. Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived.

Answer: D. Explanation: Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Global South agency?

A. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. B. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. C. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. D. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed.

Answer: A. Explanation: Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Global South agency?

A. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. B. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. C. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. D. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed.

Answer: B. Explanation: Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Global South agency?

A. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. B. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. C. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. D. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform.

Answer: C. Explanation: Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Global South agency?

A. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. B. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. C. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. D. Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order.

Answer: D. Explanation: Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies India's bounded relevance?

A. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. B. Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. C. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. D. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed.

Answer: A. Explanation: For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under India's bounded relevance?

A. Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. B. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. C. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. D. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform.

Answer: B. Explanation: For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of India's bounded relevance?

A. Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. B. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. C. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. D. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult.

Answer: C. Explanation: For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about India's bounded relevance?

A. Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. B. Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. C. Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. D. For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned.

Answer: D. Explanation: For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

12. Source, historiography and PYQ control

Control	Binding rule
FACT: Repository-​first	Official syllabus map and canonical Basic owner define scope
FACT: OCR book	Norman Lowe supplies the narrative and explicitly asks why the Cold War ended and how international relations changed; no unsupported page quotation is invented
FACT: Official historical checks	German Federal Foreign Office controls Two Plus Four chronology; UN Resolution 678 controls the Gulf legal category; US State Department history controls the dissolution sequence
FACT: Live/​changeable claim	The National Museum of American Diplomacy's October 2026 opening is separately dated and institutionally sourced; it proves only current public-​history attention
ANALYSIS: Historiography	Structuralist, agency-​centred, Western-​triumphalist, nationalist and postcolonial readings must be tested against named evidence
FACT: PYQ ownership	No direct 2018-​2025 UPSC question is verified as owned solely by Topic 21 in the local routing ledgers; probable questions remain original practice

10. Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

- **Owned core:** Gorbachev's reform, the Eastern European revolutions of

1989, German reunification in 1990, the failed August 1991 coup, dissolution of the USSR in December 1991 and the contested post-Cold-War order of Gulf enforcement, unipolarity, integration, regional wars, globalisation and continuing non-Western agency.

- **Boundary:** Topic 15 owns the whole Cold War's structure and long

chronology; Topic 17 owns China's revolutionary and reform trajectory; Topic 20 owns thematic global economy and population. Topic 21 owns the focused end phase and new-order debate without annexing those owners; Economy and International Relations retain India's detailed 1991 reform and strategic-autonomy records.

- **Date control:** Gorbachev (1985), Poland's opening (1988-89), Berlin Wall

(9 November 1989), Two Plus Four (12 September 1990), reunification (3 October 1990), Resolution 678 (29 November 1990), failed Soviet coup (August 1991), Gorbachev's resignation (25 December 1991), Maastricht (1992-93), Dayton (1995), Kosovo/NATO (1999) and EU enlargement (2004) remain distinct stages and legal categories.

- **Mechanism control:** stagnation, nationality pressures, legitimacy loss,

arms burdens, reform sequencing, social mobilisation, non-coercion and diplomacy interacted; republican institutions, Yeltsin and the failed coup explain dissolution. Neither one leader nor Western pressure alone is sufficient. Gulf Council alignment was coalition enforcement, not ordinary peacekeeping, and a US-led unipolar moment did not erase regional, Global South or Indian agency.

- **Verified PYQ ownership, 2018-2025:** only locally verified routes may be

retained with their exact metadata status; the hostile ledger finds zero direct Topic-21-only routes. German, UN, US and MEA official pages control named historical/current claims. No end-of-history teleology, present-day analogy, objective key or current forecast is invented.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why did Gorbachev's reforms destabilise the system he intended to save? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Openness legalised criticism while partial restructuring disrupted command without quickly supplying prosperity, institutional trust or a stable replacement order.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union.
- Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed.
- Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed.

Qualified conclusion: Openness legalised criticism while partial restructuring disrupted command without quickly supplying prosperity, institutional trust or a stable replacement order.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Why did Gorbachev's reforms destabilise the system he intended to save? Answer in about 150...", every clause and time boundary, chronological-causal organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified global verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Openness legalised criticism while partial restructuring disrupted command without quickly supplying prosperity, institutional trust or a stable replacement order.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

Counter-position / limit: No single actor, battle, treaty, ideology or economic pressure should be made sufficient where the evidence shows interaction among structures, triggers, agency and uneven regional outcomes.

Qualified conclusion: Openness legalised criticism while partial restructuring disrupted command without quickly supplying prosperity, institutional trust or a stable replacement order.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis and a spatial-temporal frame; organise three named events, treaties, actors, regions, institutions or attributed interpretations as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes structure, trigger and outcome, connects evidence to mechanism, includes non-European agency and avoids teleology, presentism and monocausal explanation.

How to improve this answer: For "Why did Gorbachev's reforms destabilise the system he intended to save? Answer in about 150...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named treaty, regional case, primary record or attributed scholarly position and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Why was German reunification both a popular revolution and a diplomatic settlement? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Protest and the Wall opening ended enforced division, while Two Plus Four diplomacy settled borders, sovereignty and the external legal framework before 3 October 1990.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script.
- The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy.

Qualified conclusion: Protest and the Wall opening ended enforced division, while Two Plus Four diplomacy settled borders, sovereignty and the external legal framework before 3 October 1990.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Why was German reunification both a popular revolution and a diplomatic settlement? Answer in...", every clause and time boundary, chronological-causal organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified global verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Protest and the Wall opening ended enforced division, while Two Plus Four diplomacy settled borders, sovereignty and the external legal framework before 3 October 1990.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

Counter-position / limit: No single actor, battle, treaty, ideology or economic pressure should be made sufficient where the evidence shows interaction among structures, triggers, agency and uneven regional outcomes.

Qualified conclusion: Protest and the Wall opening ended enforced division, while Two Plus Four diplomacy settled borders, sovereignty and the external legal framework before 3 October 1990.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis and a spatial-temporal frame; organise three named events, treaties, actors, regions, institutions or attributed interpretations as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes structure, trigger and outcome, connects evidence to mechanism, includes non-European agency and avoids teleology, presentism and monocausal explanation.

How to improve this answer: For "Why was German reunification both a popular revolution and a diplomatic settlement? Answer in...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named treaty, regional case, primary record or attributed scholarly position and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Why did the Cold War end? Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Structural burdens created vulnerability; Gorbachev's reforms and restraint changed the rules; organised societies, national movements and diplomacy converted crisis into a largely negotiated ending.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform.
- Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult.
- Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route.
- East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script.

Qualified conclusion: Structural burdens created vulnerability; Gorbachev's reforms and restraint changed the rules; organised societies, national movements and diplomacy converted crisis into a largely negotiated ending.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Why did the Cold War end? Answer in about 250 words.", every clause and time boundary, chronological-causal organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified global verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Structural burdens created vulnerability; Gorbachev's reforms and restraint changed the rules; organised societies, national movements and diplomacy converted crisis into a largely negotiated ending.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

Counter-position / limit: No single actor, battle, treaty, ideology or economic pressure should be made sufficient where the evidence shows interaction among structures, triggers, agency and uneven regional outcomes.

Qualified conclusion: Structural burdens created vulnerability; Gorbachev's reforms and restraint changed the rules; organised societies, national movements and diplomacy converted crisis into a largely negotiated ending.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis and a spatial-temporal frame; organise five named events, treaties, actors, regions, institutions or attributed interpretations as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes structure, trigger and outcome, connects evidence to mechanism, includes non-European agency and avoids teleology, presentism and monocausal explanation.

How to improve this answer: For “Why did the Cold War end? Answer in about 250 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named treaty, regional case, primary record or attributed scholarly position and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Explain the dissolution dynamics of the Soviet Union. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Republican sovereignty claims, Yeltsin's rival Russian centre and the failed August coup destroyed union and party authority, culminating in republican exit and Gorbachev's resignation.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened.
- Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU.
- The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union.
- Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change.

Qualified conclusion: Republican sovereignty claims, Yeltsin's rival Russian centre and the failed August coup destroyed union and party authority, culminating in republican exit and Gorbachev's resignation.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Explain the dissolution dynamics of the Soviet Union. Answer in about 250 words.”, every clause and time boundary, chronological-causal organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified global verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Republican sovereignty claims, Yeltsin's rival Russian centre and the failed August coup destroyed union and party authority, culminating in republican exit and Gorbachev's resignation.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

Counter-position / limit: No single actor, battle, treaty, ideology or economic pressure should be made sufficient where the evidence shows interaction among structures, triggers, agency and uneven regional outcomes.

Qualified conclusion: Republican sovereignty claims, Yeltsin's rival Russian centre and the failed August coup destroyed union and party authority, culminating in republican exit and Gorbachev's resignation.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis and a spatial-temporal frame; organise five named events, treaties, actors, regions, institutions or attributed interpretations

as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes structure, trigger and outcome, connects evidence to mechanism, includes non-European agency and avoids teleology, presentism and monocausal explanation.

How to improve this answer: For “Explain the dissolution dynamics of the Soviet Union. Answer in about 250 words.”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named treaty, regional case, primary record or attributed scholarly position and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Did the Gulf War inaugurate a durable new world order? Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Council alignment and US-led capability reversed interstate aggression, but Yugoslavia and NATO's contested adaptation showed that civil wars, legitimacy and sovereignty lacked one accepted enforcement formula.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait.
- The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government.
- Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred.
- Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation.

Qualified conclusion: Council alignment and US-led capability reversed interstate aggression, but Yugoslavia and NATO's contested adaptation showed that civil wars, legitimacy and sovereignty lacked one accepted enforcement formula.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Did the Gulf War inaugurate a durable new world order? Answer in about 300 words.”, every clause and time boundary, chronological-causal organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified global verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Council alignment and US-led capability reversed interstate aggression, but Yugoslavia and NATO's contested adaptation showed that civil wars, legitimacy and sovereignty lacked one accepted enforcement formula.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

Counter-position / limit: No single actor, battle, treaty, ideology or economic pressure should be made sufficient where the evidence shows interaction among structures, triggers, agency and uneven regional outcomes.

Qualified conclusion: Council alignment and US-led capability reversed interstate aggression, but Yugoslavia and NATO's contested adaptation showed that civil wars, legitimacy and sovereignty lacked one accepted enforcement formula.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis and a spatial-temporal frame; organise six to eight named events, treaties, actors, regions, institutions or attributed interpretations as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes structure, trigger and outcome, connects evidence to mechanism, includes non-European agency and avoids teleology, presentism and monocausal explanation.

How to improve this answer: For "Did the Gulf War inaugurate a durable new world order? Answer in about 300 words.", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named treaty, regional case, primary record or attributed scholarly position and state what that evidence cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Assess the post-1991 order from a Global South and Indian perspective. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: EU enlargement and globalisation widened integration, but unequal capacity and sovereign bargaining survived; India recalibrated partnerships and economic policy without accepting a single Western endpoint.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states.
- Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived.
- Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order.
- For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned.

Qualified conclusion: EU enlargement and globalisation widened integration, but unequal capacity and sovereign bargaining survived; India recalibrated partnerships and economic policy without accepting a single Western endpoint.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the post-1991 order from a Global South and Indian perspective. Answer in about 300...", every clause and time boundary, chronological-causal organisation, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified global verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: EU enlargement and globalisation widened integration, but unequal capacity and sovereign bargaining survived; India recalibrated partnerships and economic policy without accepting a single Western endpoint.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep

its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned. **Analysis:** Use this evidence to establish the mechanism asked in the directive, not merely to narrate the event. **Qualification:** Keep its chronological, regional and interpretive boundary explicit.

Counter-position / limit: No single actor, battle, treaty, ideology or economic pressure should be made sufficient where the evidence shows interaction among structures, triggers, agency and uneven regional outcomes.

Qualified conclusion: EU enlargement and globalisation widened integration, but unequal capacity and sovereign bargaining survived; India recalibrated partnerships and economic policy without accepting a single Western endpoint.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis and a spatial-temporal frame; organise six to eight named events, treaties, actors, regions, institutions or attributed interpretations as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes structure, trigger and outcome, connects evidence to mechanism, includes non-European agency and avoids teleology, presentism and monocausal explanation.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess the post-1991 order from a Global South and Indian perspective. Answer in about 300...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named treaty, regional case, primary record or attributed scholarly position and state what that evidence cannot prove.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: History (World History) · **Tier:** Advanced (analysis + answer writing) · **GS Paper:** GS-I with GS-II linkage
Grounded in: Norman Lowe, *Mastering Modern World History* (5th ed.), Chapter 18, Chapter 10 and Chapter 12 + official UPSC syllabus lines + dated current-affairs continuity note. **FACT:** = from Lowe / official syllabus · **ANALYSIS:** = synthesis / Lowe's judgement · **CURRENT:** = post-2013 current affairs. *Companion:* basic/21_Cold-War-End-and-New-World-Order.md.

1. The key debate: what ended the Cold War and dissolved the USSR?

Explanation	How to use it
FACT: Economic stagnation	Shows the structural weakness of the command economy
FACT: Reform sequencing failure	Glasnost released criticism faster than perestroika delivered results
FACT: Nationalist centrifugal pull	Republics no longer accepted tight Moscow control
FACT: Yeltsin's radical challenge	Reform split the elite and created a rival centre of authority
FACT: Arms and imperial burdens	Defence competition and Afghanistan narrowed the resources and legitimacy available for renewal
FACT: Western pressure and diplomacy	Reagan-era pressure mattered, but so did his response to Gorbachev's initiatives
FACT: Eastern European society	Solidarity and other national movements converted Soviet restraint into regime change
ANALYSIS: Best answer	Combine structural weakness, reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and the choice not to use mass force

Historiographical control

- ANALYSIS: A **Western-triumphalist** account stresses arms pressure and US resolve; it explains an external constraint but understates Soviet reform choices and Eastern European agency.
- ANALYSIS: A **structuralist** account stresses stagnation, technology and nationality contradictions;

it explains vulnerability but not why collapse occurred in 1989-91 rather than earlier.

- ANALYSIS: An **agency-centred** account stresses Gorbachev, Yeltsin and Reagan; it explains decisions but can exaggerate individual freedom from institutions and inherited crises.
- ANALYSIS: A **social-history** account restores workers, churches, civic networks and demonstrators; it must still distinguish Poland, Hungary, East Germany, Czechoslovakia and Romania.
- ANALYSIS: A **postcolonial** account questions the claim that one Western model became history's universal endpoint; it directs attention to hierarchy, sovereignty and unequal globalisation.

2. Gorbachev, Yeltsin and the aftermath

Figure /​ phase	Main point
FACT: Gorbachev	Tried to humanize and rescue socialism, not abolish it
FACT: Yeltsin	Favoured much faster market change and a looser union
FACT: Shock therapy	Post-​1991 reform produced inflation, unemployment, oligarchic wealth and social misery
FACT: Putin era in Lowe	Restored state authority more effectively than liberal credibility

- ANALYSIS: Lowe's post-1991 Russia sections are especially useful for Mains because they show that **the collapse of communism did not automatically create a healthy democracy or a fair market economy.**

Dissolution as a state process, not a single resignation

Stage	Mechanism
FACT: Republican sovereignty	Union-​republic institutions became vehicles for independence
FACT: Russian dual power	Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a rival centre to Gorbachev's union presidency
FACT: August 1991 coup	Failed conservative restoration shattered CPSU authority and accelerated exits
FACT: December 1991	Republican decisions ended the union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December

ANALYSIS: Advanced verdict: **reform weakened party control, but the union dissolved because territorial institutions, republican elites and nationality movements could convert that weakness into sovereign exit.**

3. German reunification: revolution completed by diplomacy

- FACT: The Berlin Wall opening on 9 November 1989 ended enforced separation but did not itself settle Germany's borders, sovereignty or alliance status.
- FACT: The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 by the two German states and the four former occupying powers.
- FACT: Legal reunification followed on 3 October 1990.
- ANALYSIS: This sequence rebuts two opposite errors: diplomacy alone did not create the popular revolution, while street mobilisation alone could not terminate the Four Powers' legal role.

4. Yugoslavia: nationalism plus failed statecraft

- FACT: Lowe does not treat Yugoslavia as an inevitable explosion of "ancient" hatred.
- FACT: Milosevic's Serbian nationalism, Tudjman's Croatian nationalism, Bosnia's mixed demography and the weakness of compromise made violence more likely.
- FACT: International response was late, hesitant and inconsistent before NATO acted more decisively.
- FACT: Bosnia and Kosovo are best remembered as tests of post-Cold-War Europe and the UN, not just Balkan history.

5. Gulf War and NATO: two tests of the new-order claim

Test	What it appeared to prove	Limit exposed
FACT: Gulf War, 1990-1991	Security Council alignment and US-led capability could reverse interstate aggression	This was coalition enforcement under Council authority, not a general UN army or a template for every conflict
FACT: Bosnia / Dayton, 1995	US diplomacy and NATO power could help end a European war after prolonged failure	Effectiveness came late, after atrocity and institutional hesitation
FACT: Kosovo, 1999	NATO had moved beyond territorial defence toward crisis intervention	Authorisation, sovereignty and selectivity remained contested

ANALYSIS: The early post-Cold-War record therefore moved from **exceptional alignment** in the Gulf to **improvised and contested intervention** in the Balkans. It did not establish a settled constitution for world order.

6. European integration: peace project, market project and sovereignty bargain

Interpretation	Evidence	Qualification
FACT: Peace-through-integration	ECSC pooled coal and steel; Franco-German cooperation became institutional	NATO and US security backing also mattered
FACT: Economic integration	EEC removed barriers and built a common market	Benefits and adjustment costs were uneven
FACT: Supranational deepening	Maastricht widened cooperation and prepared monetary union	Member states retained major powers and contested centralization
FACT: Post-Cold-War widening	2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states	Widening made institutional and distributive tensions more complex

ANALYSIS: Advanced synthesis: **European integration was neither an inevitable federal march nor a mere free-trade arrangement; it was a repeatedly renegotiated bargain among peace, prosperity, national sovereignty and geopolitical anchoring.**

7. Was there really a "new world order"?

Claim	Counterpoint
FACT: 1991 seemed unipolar	The USA appeared unrivalled after Soviet collapse
FACT: NATO / UN activism expanded	Gulf enforcement and Balkan intervention became more visible
FACT: European integration deepened and widened	Maastricht and eastern enlargement institutionalised a new European map
FACT: Globalisation accelerated	Markets and production networks supported a liberal-convergence narrative
WRONG: Stability or equality did not follow	Yugoslavia, post-Soviet disruption and uneven adjustment exposed disorder and hierarchy
ANALYSIS: Better phrase	a unipolar moment inside a still plural and unequal international society

8. Globalisation, postcolonial agency and India

- ANALYSIS: Topic 20 owns the economic history. In Topic 21, globalisation matters only as an ideological and institutional component of the new-order claim: market opening appeared to accompany political convergence, but debt, unequal capacity and distributional conflict survived.
- ANALYSIS: Postcolonial states retained agency through the UN, regional organisations, issue coalitions and diversified partnerships. "Global South" is an analytical category, not a uniform bloc or a passive zone.
- ANALYSIS: India faced simultaneous strategic and economic recalibration in 1991. Soviet collapse

altered the external setting; the balance-of-payments crisis accelerated domestic reform. India subsequently diversified partnerships while retaining decision-making autonomy.

- ANALYSIS: Do not duplicate India detail here. Economy owns the 1991 reform package and International Relations owns strategic autonomy.

9. Source and current-claim discipline

- FACT: Norman Lowe's fifth edition supplies historical narrative through its 2013 publication boundary; later changeable claims must not be projected backward into his account.

- FACT: Official German, UN and US historical records control the Two Plus Four, Gulf War legal category and Soviet-dissolution dates used in the Basic owner.

- CURRENT: The US State Department's National Museum of American Diplomacy says it will open to the public in October 2026 and identifies its signed Berlin Wall segment. This is only a dated public-history anchor, not evidence for any causal interpretation.

- FACT: No direct 2018-2025 UPSC PYQ is verified as owned solely by Topic 21 in the local routing ledgers. Do not convert Lowe's end-of-chapter question or an original practice prompt into a claimed UPSC PYQ.

10. Must-Know Facts (Prelims) and UPSC Traps

- FACT: The Berlin Wall fell in November 1989; the USSR itself was formally dissolved in December 1991 - these are two distinct milestones roughly two years apart, not the same event.

- FACT: Two Plus Four was signed on 12 September 1990; German reunification took effect on 3 October 1990.

- FACT: Gorbachev's twin reforms were glasnost (openness) and perestroika (restructuring); Lowe stresses that glasnost released criticism faster than perestroika delivered economic results.

- FACT: The August 1991 coup failed and accelerated the collapse of union and party authority.

- FACT: Resolution 678 of 29 November 1990 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline; the Gulf War was not ordinary blue-helmet peacekeeping.

- FACT: Yugoslavia's break-up produced distinct conflicts in Bosnia and later Kosovo, with NATO intervention coming only after a slow, hesitant international response.

- FACT: Treaty of Rome (1957), Maastricht (signed 1992; effective 1993) and the 2004 enlargement are distinct stages of European integration.

- WRONG: Reform automatically saves rigid systems -> reform can also accelerate collapse.

- WRONG: USSR breakup equals democratic success -> the 1990s Russian experience was far more turbulent.

- WRONG: Western victory alone explains 1989-91 -> internal structures, reform, national movements and negotiated diplomacy were indispensable.

- WRONG: Wall opening equals reunification -> popular opening and legal-diplomatic settlement were separate stages.

- WRONG: NATO intervention in the Balkans proves the UN system worked smoothly -> Lowe's narrative stresses delay, disagreement and improvisation.

- WRONG: Gulf War coalition action was a permanent UN army -> member states acted under Council authorisation.

- WRONG: The EU is simply the old EEC with a new name -> Maastricht broadened integration, while later enlargement changed its political geography.

11. Mains answer framework and probable questions

Question type	Suggested flow
Why communism collapsed	stagnation -> reform -> nationalism -> elite split -> conclusion
Assess new world order	Gulf alignment -> unipolar capability -> Balkan limits -> EU/globalisation -> Global South qualification
Post-Soviet Russia	Yeltsin chaos -> oligarchs -> shock therapy -> Putin restoration -> balanced judgement
European integration	postwar peace logic -> common market -> Maastricht deepening -> eastern enlargement -> sovereignty tensions

- "Gorbachev tried to reform communism but ended by dissolving it." Comment.
- Was the Cold War ended more by Soviet weakness, Western pressure or political choice?
- Explain why German reunification was both a popular revolution and a diplomatic settlement.
- Why did the breakup of Yugoslavia become the most violent crisis of post-Cold-War Europe?
- Critically examine the idea of a "new world order" after 1991.
- Did the Gulf War demonstrate a durable post-Cold-War order?
- Assess the post-1991 order from a postcolonial and Indian perspective.
- Was European integration driven more by peace, economics or geopolitical strategy? Discuss.

12. Study link

Study link: revise the narrative skeleton in `basic/21_Cold-War-End-and-New-World-Order.md`, then return here for debate language, post-Soviet Russia and NATO/UN evaluation.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Reform paradox

INTENT -> rescue a humane Soviet socialism
 GLASNOST -> criticism becomes legitimate
 PERESTROIKA -> command is disrupted
 SEQUENCING -> expectations outrun results
 MUST REMEMBER: Gorbachev's reform phase, Eastern European revolutions of 1989, Two Plus Four settlement and German reunification in 1990, failed August 1991 coup and December Soviet dissolution are distinct stages.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Why the Cold War ended

STRUCTURE -> stagnation, technology and arms burdens
AGENCY -> Gorbachev, Yeltsin and Reagan choices
SOCIETY -> opposition and nationality mobilisation
VERDICT -> interaction, not Western victory alone

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Eastern Europe, 1988-89

POLAND -> Solidarity, negotiation and elections
HUNGARY -> reform and border opening
CZECHOSLOVAKIA -> peaceful Velvet Revolution
ROMANIA -> violent overthrow; no single script

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Germany's negotiated reunification

9 NOV 1989 -> Berlin Wall opens
POPULAR PRESSURE -> division becomes untenable
12 SEP 1990 -> Two Plus Four Treaty signed
3 OCT 1990 -> legal reunification

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Soviet dissolution chain

REPUBLICS -> sovereignty and Baltic exits
YELTSIN -> rival Russian authority
AUG 1991 COUP -> fails and breaks CPSU power
25 DEC 1991 -> Gorbachev resigns; union ends

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Gulf War order test

IRAQ -> occupies Kuwait
RESOLUTION 678 -> authorises all necessary means
US-LED COALITION -> reverses occupation
CATEGORY -> Council-authorised enforcement, not peacekeeping

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Unipolarity's three tests

CAPABILITY -> unmatched US reach
LEGITIMACY -> consent remains necessary
CONTROL -> regional actors retain agency
ORDER -> power plus rules, institutions and acceptance

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Yugoslavia and NATO

FEDERAL COLLAPSE -> territorial nationalism
1991-95 -> war, cleansing and delayed response
1995 -> Dayton ends Bosnia war
1999 -> Kosovo intervention tests NATO legitimacy

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: European integration settlement

1951-57 -> ECSC and EEC roots
1992-93 -> Maastricht deepens union
2004 -> eastern enlargement
TENSION -> widening, sovereignty and unequal adjustment

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Globalisation and postcolonial agency

NETWORKS -> trade, finance and production integrate
ASYMMETRY -> gains and policy space remain unequal
GLOBAL SOUTH -> bargains through institutions and coalitions
LIMIT -> convergence is a claim, not a law
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Economic stagnation, nationality pressures, legitimacy loss, arms burdens, reform sequencing, social mobilisation, non-coercion and diplomacy interacted; neither Western pressure nor one leader alone is sufficient.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: India after the systemic rupture

STRATEGIC SHOCK -> Soviet setting disappears
ECONOMIC SHOCK -> 1991 balance-of-payments crisis
RESPONSE -> diversified partnerships and reform
BOUNDARY -> Economy and IR own the detailed verdict
EVIDENCE LIMIT: The Gulf coalition displayed US-led unipolar capability, while Yugoslavia, NATO controversy, unequal globalisation and continuing Global South and Indian agency deny final-peace or Western-teleology claims.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Cold War end answer spine

END -> structure, reform, mobilisation and diplomacy
DISSOLUTION -> republics, Yeltsin, coup and exit
ORDER -> Gulf alignment, Balkans, EU and globalisation
VERDICT -> unipolar moment without final Western settlement

Cold War End and New World Order: RAPID CHRONOLOGY AND ARGUMENT MAP

1. **Gorbachev's reform intent, 1985:** Gorbachev sought to reform and save Soviet socialism rather than deliberately destroy communism or dissolve the union.
2. **Glasnost:** Glasnost widened openness, public criticism and political participation before a trusted replacement order had formed.
3. **Perestroika:** Perestroika tried to restructure party, state and economy but disrupted command mechanisms before a functioning market or decentralised system existed.
4. **Structural burdens:** Economic stagnation, technological weakness, consumer shortages, defence expenditure and the Afghan war narrowed Soviet legitimacy and room for reform.
5. **Multi-causal end debate:** Structural weakness made reform urgent; reform, mobilisation, nationality politics, diplomacy and non-use of mass force made reversal increasingly difficult.
6. **Poland and Hungary, 1988-89:** Solidarity forced negotiation and elections in Poland, while Hungarian reform and border opening weakened the regional system through a different route.
7. **Eastern Europe and the Wall, 1989:** East German protest and elite division opened the Berlin Wall on 9 November, Czechoslovakia changed peacefully, and Romania's violent overthrow disproved a single 1989 script.
8. **German reunification, 1990:** The Two Plus Four Treaty was signed on 12 September 1990 and legal reunification followed on 3 October, joining popular revolution to great-power diplomacy.
9. **Republican sovereignty:** Baltic and other union republics used territorial institutions to move from autonomy demands toward sovereign exit as Moscow weakened.
10. **Yeltsin as rival centre:** Boris Yeltsin used the Russian republic as a competing democratic and territorial centre against Gorbachev's union presidency and the CPSU.
11. **Failed coup, August 1991:** The hard-line coup failed, shattered remaining Communist Party authority and accelerated republican departures instead of restoring the union.
12. **Soviet dissolution, December 1991:** Republican exits ended the fifteen-republic union; Gorbachev resigned on 25 December, so dissolution was more than a Moscow government change.

13. **Gulf War order test, 1990-91:** Security Council Resolution 678 authorised cooperating member states to use all necessary means after the deadline, enabling a US-led coalition to reverse Iraq's occupation of Kuwait.
14. **US unipolar moment and limits:** The United States possessed unmatched global reach after Soviet collapse, but predominant capability did not create universal legitimacy, unlimited control or world government.
15. **Yugoslav fragmentation:** Communist federal breakdown, leadership choices, mixed settlement and territorial nationalism produced wars and ethnic cleansing rather than an inevitable release of ancient hatred.
16. **NATO after bipolarity:** Dayton ended the Bosnian war in 1995 but not Kosovo; NATO's 1999 intervention showed adaptation beyond territorial defence and controversy over sovereignty and authorisation.
17. **European Union settlement:** ECSC and EEC roots preceded 1991; Maastricht deepened union in 1992-93 and the 2004 enlargement incorporated many former communist states.
18. **Globalisation within the order:** Expanding trade, finance and production networks strengthened liberal-convergence claims while unequal capacity, adjustment costs and policy-space conflicts survived.
19. **Global South agency:** Postcolonial states continued bargaining through the UN, regional organisations and issue coalitions; they were neither a uniform bloc nor passive recipients of Western order.
20. **India's bounded relevance:** For India, Soviet collapse and the 1991 balance-of-payments crisis required strategic and economic recalibration, while detailed liberalisation and strategic-autonomy content remains Economy- and IR-owned.

Cold War End and New World Order: CLOSE-OPTION AND CAUSAL TRAPS

- Do not say Gorbachev intended to destroy communism.
- Do not treat glasnost and perestroika as synonyms.
- Do not explain the Cold War's end through stagnation, Western pressure or one leader alone.
- Do not omit the choice not to use old-style Soviet force.
- Do not portray eastern European societies as passive or their routes as identical.
- Do not merge the Berlin Wall opening, Two Plus Four Treaty and German reunification.
- Do not omit the failed August 1991 coup from dissolution dynamics.
- Do not say the USSR simply became Russia.
- Do not say communism's collapse disproved every form of socialism.
- Do not explain Yugoslavia through timeless ancient hatreds.
- Do not treat Dayton as a settlement of Kosovo.
- Do not call the Gulf War ordinary UN blue-helmet peacekeeping.
- Do not say European integration began after 1991.
- Do not date Maastricht only to 1992 or only to 1993.
- Do not equate unipolar power with universal legitimacy.
- Do not treat globalisation as equal convergence or annex Topic 20's economic history.
- Do not portray the Global South as one bloc without agency.
- Do not duplicate India's 1991 reforms or strategic-autonomy doctrine from their owners.
- Do not convert probable questions into claimed UPSC PYQs.

Cold War End and New World Order: ANSWER-WRITING SPINE

DEFINE THE HISTORICAL PROBLEM -> ORDER THE CHRONOLOGY
-> GROUP NAMED EVIDENCE BY MECHANISM -> TEST EXCLUSIONS AND LIMITS
-> LINK CONSEQUENCES TO THE NEXT PHASE -> GIVE A GRADED VERDICT

Cold War End and New World Order: CURRENT-LINK BOUNDARY

The U.S. State Department's National Museum of American Diplomacy is scheduled to open to the public in October 2026 and houses a signed Berlin Wall segment associated with major actors in the diplomacy of 1989-91 and German reunification. The changeable opening claim was rechecked on 4 September 2026. Official US, German, UN and Indian pages separately control Soviet dissolution, Two Plus Four, Resolution 678 and India's post-Cold-War recalibration. The museum object is only a public-history link, not evidence for a single-cause Cold War ending or a final Western 'new world order'.